

Case Study – Enterprise Information Governance Investigation

Microsoft Purview Integrated Governance Scenario

Background

A global consulting organization is advising a multinational financial and healthcare client during a confidential acquisition initiative called:

Project Falcon

The engagement involves:

- financial due diligence
- regulatory analysis
- legal review
- audit evidence collection
- AI-assisted reporting
- executive collaboration

The organization uses:

- Microsoft Teams
- Microsoft SharePoint
- Microsoft OneDrive
- Microsoft Outlook
- Microsoft Purview

The organization recently implemented:

- Sensitive Information Types (SIT)
- Exact Data Match (EDM)
- Sensitivity Labels
- Microsoft Purview Encryption
- Data Loss Prevention (DLP)
- Endpoint DLP
- Insider Risk Management
- Adaptive Protection

- Audit Premium
- Content Search
- eDiscovery

Business Scenario

A senior consultant working on Project Falcon submits resignation notice.

Within the next several days, the following activities are detected:

- Large SharePoint downloads
- Multiple after-hours access attempts
- Browser uploads from unmanaged browsers
- USB copy activity from corporate endpoint
- Local copies of financial spreadsheets
- External email forwarding attempts
- Teams file sharing outside approved channels
- AI prompt submissions into unmanaged AI tools
- Deletion of several local files after activity

The organization receives:

- DLP alerts
- Endpoint DLP alerts
- Elevated Insider Risk alerts
- Audit activity anomalies

Adaptive Protection automatically increases enforcement controls for the user.

Legal and compliance teams now require:

- investigation evidence
- activity timelines
- impacted data analysis
- defensible reporting
- governance improvement recommendations

Your Role

You are part of the:

Enterprise Governance & Investigation Team

Your responsibility is to:

- investigate the incident
- identify governance gaps
- determine data exposure
- evaluate Microsoft Purview controls
- recommend remediation actions

Investigation Objectives

Your team must determine:

WHAT HAPPENED?

WHAT DATA WAS INVOLVED?

WHO ACCESSED THE DATA?

WAS DATA EXFILTRATED?

WHICH CONTROLS WORKED?

WHAT GOVERNANCE IMPROVEMENTS ARE REQUIRED?

Task 1 – Data Discovery & Classification

Objective

Identify how Microsoft Purview detects and classifies sensitive information.

Questions

1. Which Microsoft Purview technology would detect:
 - credit card numbers
 - bank account numbers
 - government IDs?
2. Which technology would help identify:

- exact customer financial records
 - payroll IDs
 - internal account numbers?
3. Which technology would identify:
- merger documents
 - audit reports
 - legal agreements
 - confidential strategy documents?
4. Which sensitivity labels would you recommend for:
- executive reports
 - merger plans
 - financial statements
 - audit evidence?
5. Explain the difference between:
- SIT
 - EDM
 - Trainable Classifiers
 - Sensitivity Labels

Task 2 – Encryption & Protection

Objective

Evaluate how information protection should be applied.

Questions

1. Which documents should be encrypted?
2. Which users should have access?
3. Should external sharing be allowed?
4. When would “Do Not Forward” be appropriate?
5. How does encryption differ from DLP?

6. How does protection remain persistent after files leave the organization?

Task 3 – DLP Investigation

Objective

Investigate sensitive data movement.

Questions

1. Which DLP policies should trigger in this scenario?
2. Which activities represent high-risk behavior?
3. Which actions should:
 - warn users
 - block activity
 - allow override with justification?
4. Which activities should generate alerts?
5. Which workloads should be monitored?
6. How does DLP differ from Endpoint DLP?

Task 4 – Endpoint Governance

Objective

Investigate endpoint-level risks.

Questions

1. Which endpoint activities are risky?
2. Should USB transfers be:
 - blocked
 - audited
 - allowed with justification?
3. Which browser activities create governance risk?
4. How can Endpoint DLP help detect:
 - clipboard usage

- local file copies
 - browser uploads
 - AI prompt submissions?
5. Why is endpoint governance critical in remote work environments?

Task 5 – Insider Risk Investigation

Objective

Analyze risky user behavior.

Questions

1. Why did the user risk score increase?
2. Which behavioral indicators contributed?
3. How did resignation status affect risk analysis?
4. Which activities indicate:
 - accidental risk
 - malicious intent?
5. How does Insider Risk Management differ from DLP?
6. Which additional telemetry would improve the investigation?

Task 6 – Adaptive Protection

Objective

Apply risk-based governance.

Questions

1. What should happen when a user becomes:
 - low risk
 - medium risk
 - elevated risk?
2. Which controls should Adaptive Protection strengthen?
3. Should elevated-risk users receive:

- stricter DLP
 - stronger access restrictions
 - longer retention
 - reduced sharing permissions?
4. How does Adaptive Protection improve traditional DLP?

Task 7 – Audit Investigation

Objective

Reconstruct the activity timeline.

Questions

1. Which audit logs should investigators review first?
2. Which activities indicate potential exfiltration?
3. Which filters are most useful during audit searches?
4. Why is Audit Premium valuable?
5. Which logs should be exported for investigation evidence?
6. How does audit retention affect investigations?

Task 8 – Content Search & eDiscovery

Objective

Locate and preserve investigation evidence.

Questions

1. Which content locations should be searched?
2. Which keywords would help identify impacted content?
3. When should the investigation escalate into eDiscovery?
4. Which exported evidence formats may be required?
5. How should legal evidence be preserved?
6. Explain the difference between:
 - Content Search

- eDiscovery

Task 9 – AI Governance

Objective

Investigate AI-related governance risks.

Scenario Update

Investigation reveals that confidential merger summaries were pasted into unmanaged AI tools.

Questions

1. Which controls should have detected this activity?
2. How can Endpoint DLP help govern AI prompts?
3. How does Insider Risk Management support AI investigations?
4. Why is AI governance becoming critical for enterprises?
5. What governance policies would you recommend for AI usage?

Final Deliverables

Your team must prepare:

1. Incident Summary

Explain:

- what occurred
- timeline of events
- impacted systems

2. Impact Assessment

Identify:

- exposed data
- business impact
- regulatory concerns

3. Governance Analysis

Evaluate:

- which Microsoft Purview controls worked
- which controls failed
- where visibility gaps existed

4. Investigation Findings

Provide:

- evidence summary
- risky behaviors identified
- exfiltration indicators
- policy violations

5. Governance Recommendations

Recommend improvements for:

- DLP
- Endpoint DLP
- Insider Risk
- Adaptive Protection